

Notrump Bidding

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Notrump bids.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

- open 1NT with 15-17 points and balanced* distribution

- open 2NT with 20-21 points and balanced* distribution

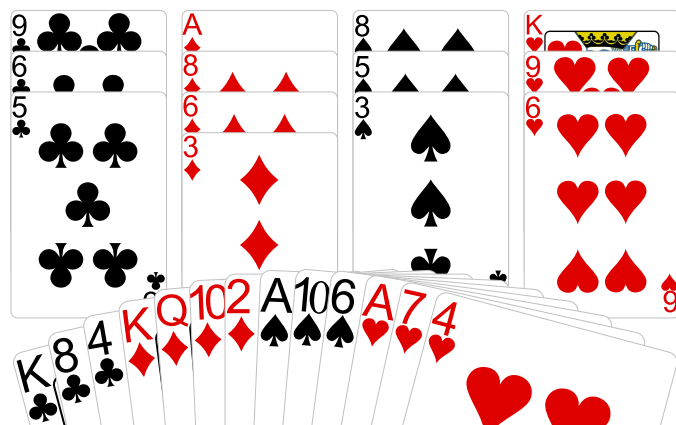
- with 25 or fewer points the partnership should stop at 1NT or 2NT

- with 26 - 32 points the partnership should bid to 3NT

- with 33 - 36 points the partnership should bid to 6NT

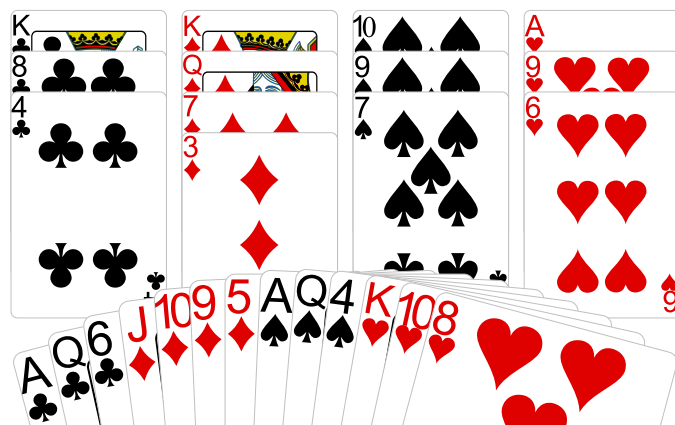
*balanced means either 4-3-3-3, 4-4-3-2 or 5-3-3-2

Deal 1 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



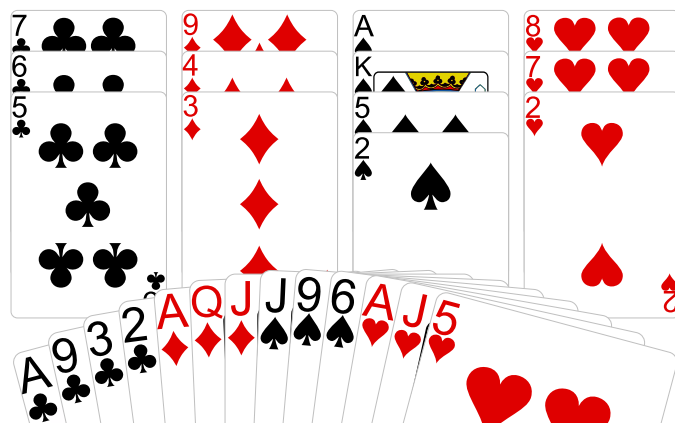
Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 3 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Deal 4 Ctr: 1NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Develop Winners				
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play	

Board: 1
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: North

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Board: 3
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: South

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 1NT
Declarer: West

Board: 5
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North

Board: 6
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East

Deal 1

West Deals
None Vul

♠ K
♥ Q J T 5
♦ J 9 7 4
♣ T 7 3 2

16
7 10
7

♠ A T 6
♥ A 7 4
♦ K Q T 2
♣ K 8 4



♠ 8 5 3
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 8 6 3
♣ 9 6 5

♠ Q J 9 7 4 2
♥ 8 3 2
♦ 5
♣ A Q J

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 1

NORTH has a perfect 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 7 points; he knows that the most points the partnership could hold is 24 (7 + 17).

Since this is below the 26 point game requirement he passes.

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT		
All Pass			
1NT by North			

Deal 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ T 9 7
♥ A 9 6
♦ K Q 7 3
♣ K 8 4

5
12 16
7

♠ K 6 5 3

♥ Q 7 4 3

♦ 8 6 2

♣ T 9



♠ J 8 2

♥ J 5 2

♦ A 4

♣ J 7 5 3 2

♠ A Q 4
♥ K T 8
♦ J T 9 5
♣ A Q 6

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 2

EAST has an ideal 1NT opening -

16 points and balanced distribution.

With 12 points, WEST knows the partnership total is between 27 and 29, enough for game

but not enough to think about slam. Since WEST also has a balanced hand she bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Deal 3

East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ Q J T 5 2
♦ 8 2
♣ J 9 4 3

14
4 6
16

♠ A J 3
♥ A 8 7
♦ Q J T 5
♣ Q T 7



♠ K Q 8 2
♥ K 9 6
♦ A 9 4
♣ A 6 5

♠ T 9 7 6
♥ 4 3
♦ K 7 6 3
♣ K 8 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT	Pass	1NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

NORTH just bids 3NT, knowing SOUTH will respect his decision and pass.

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 3

SOUTH has 16 points and balanced distribution.

She naturally opens 1NT.

NORTH has 14 points and balanced distribution so he does the math.

The partnership has at least 29 points (14 + 15).

The partnership has at most 31 points (14 + 17).

Since this is more than the 26 needed for game, but fewer than the 33 needed for slam

Deal 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 6
♥ A J 5
♦ A Q J
♣ A 9 3 2

8
17 7
8

♠ Q T
♥ K T 4
♦ T 8 6 5 2
♣ Q J 8



♠ 8 7 4 3
♥ Q 9 6 3
♦ K 7
♣ K T 4

♠ A K 5 2
♥ 8 7 2
♦ 9 4 3
♣ 7 6 5

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 4

When WEST opens 1NT, EAST knows that he cannot have more

than 17 points. So with her 7 points, she knows there is no reason to respond.

West	North	East	South
1NT			
All Pass			
1NT by West			

Deal 5

West Deals
None Vul

♠ A 7 4
♥ T 8 6
♦ T 7 6 2
♣ A 8 2

17
8 6
9

♠ K Q J
♥ Q J 9 5
♦ A J 8
♣ Q J T



♠ T 8 6 3
♥ K 4 2
♦ K 4 3
♣ K 7 5

♠ 9 5 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ Q 9 5
♣ 9 6 4 3

West	North	East	South
Pass	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
accepts the invitation.

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 5

NORTH has a maximum 17 point 1NT opener.

SOUTH has 9 points:

- if NORTH has 15 the total is 24, not enough for game.

- if NORTH has 17 the total is 26, enough for game.

Since SOUTH doesn't know what to do he passes the buck back to NORTH

by bidding 2NT; this is an invitation for NORTH to bid game.

NORTH has a maximum 17 point hand so she

Deal 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 8 4
 ♥ K 7 2
 ♦ Q 6 5
 ♣ K J 9 3

6
 9 17
 8

♠ K Q J 5

♥ 9 5 3

♦ 7 3 2

♣ 7 6 2



♠ 3 2

♥ J T 8 6

♦ K T 9 8

♣ A 5 4

♠ A 9 7 6

♥ A Q 4

♦ A J 4

♣ Q T 8

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Baker Bidpractice/Set1 6

With 9 points WEST is unable to decide the final contract. If EAST has 17 points then the partnership

should be playing 3NT. If EAST opened with just 15 points then 3NT will be too high..

So WEST makes the temporizing bid of 2NT. This tells EAST that he must make the final call - go on to

game if he has maximum, pass if he has minimum. On this Deal EAST has 17 points so he bids 3NT.